

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 8 3

♥ A 6 2

♦ J 4

♣ J 10 9 2

♠ 6 2

♥ Q 10 4

♦ 10 9 6 5 3

♣ A Q 7



♠ J 10 7 4

♥ 7 3

♦ K Q 8 2

♣ 5 4 3

♠ K Q 5

♥ K J 9 8 5

♦ A 7

♣ K 8 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♣

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

the same invitational quality to it, but it will give partner the information about where you could use some help. This is called a Help Suit Game Try. In this case you bid 3♣.

You have a valid opening 1NT bid. You also have a valid opening 1♥ bid. It is up to you and your partner to agree on whether you will open 1NT when you hold a 5-card Major.

For the purpose of this Deal, and not choosing sides, you open 1♥. Partner responds 2♥.

You agree on Where, now you must figure out How High. Add partner's 6-10 to your 17 and you get 23-27. In other words you might have enough for game if partner has a maximum.

You want to make an invitational bid and it is ok to now bid 3♥. Partner will understand what you mean and will either pass or bid 4♥, depending on his hand.

But you can also bid any other suit and it will have the same invitational quality to it, but it will give partner the information about where you could use some help. This is called a Help Suit Game Try. In this case you bid 3♣.

Partner, with 9 points and help for ♣s, bids 4♥.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣J.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣J.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

The ♠A and the ♥A definitely won't go away. And the ♦ loser is pretty sure also. However, the second ♠ loser can be eliminated either by leading up to the ♠ K Q 5 or by ruffing it in dummy.

Suppose you win the ♣ and play one round of trumps. Oops, it is now too late to make the contract. Someone can win the ♥A and play another ♥. Then, whoever takes the ♠A can lead a third ♥ and you can no longer ruff your ♠.

Try this instead. Win the ♣ in dummy and play a small ♠ to your ♠Q. Assume West wins the ♠A and leads ♥A and another ♥. You win this in your hand, play ♠K and ruff your last ♠ with dummy's last trump. Now get to your hand, pull trumps and give up a ♦ at the end.

Leading even one round of trumps would be a mistake.

Suppose when you led toward your ♠Q it held the trick. Would you be convinced that East musthold the ♠A and change your plan? Would you then pull trumps and let your contract depend on that assumption? I hope not.

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 7 3
♥ K J 7 4
♦ Q 10 9 3
♣ 4

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ Q 6

♦ A K 4 2

♣ K 7 3



♠ 9 8 5

♥ A 5 3 2

♦ J 7

♣ J 9 6 5

♠ A K

♥ 10 9 8

♦ 8 6 5

♣ A Q 10 8 2

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1♣
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

With 14 points and only one biddable suit this was a snap. You open 1♣. Partner responds with 1♠.

This one isn't such a snap. You sure cannot support ♠s with only 2 of them, even good ones. You aren't supposed to rebid your ♣s without a 6-card suit. You hate to bid Notrump with neither of the two red suits stopped, and you cannot pass. So you bite the bullet and say 1NT. Partner jumps it to 3NT and you pass, hoping he can stop the red suits.

South plays 3NT. It turns out partner can't stop ♥s either and the defenders reel off 4 ♥ tricks, then lead a small ♦.

South plays 3NT. The defenders win 4 ♥ tricks, then play a small ♦.

Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 3 : Total = 7

You need 2 more tricks and you expect to get them from ♣s. This should have been evident while they were leading all those ♥ winners so you would not have discarded one of the ♣s from your hand. But you also had to be careful not to discard even one of dummy's ♣s, you need all three of them.

If the ♣s split 3-2 it wouldn't matter, but if East happens to have ♣ J x x x then you will need dummy's third ♣ to make a finesse. You first play your ♣A, then lead a small ♣ to dummy's ♣K. West shows out on this ♣ so you know that East has ♣ J 9 left. You lead dummy's ♣7, finessing East out of the ♣J.

Suppose you had incorrectly discarded dummy's ♣3 on one of those ♥s. You would have played the ♣s by first leading small to the ♣K (West following) then the ♣7 back toward your hand. It is true that you **COULD** finesse now but you wouldn't know that you **SHOULD** since you wouldn't know that West was now void.

This was a very difficult hand.